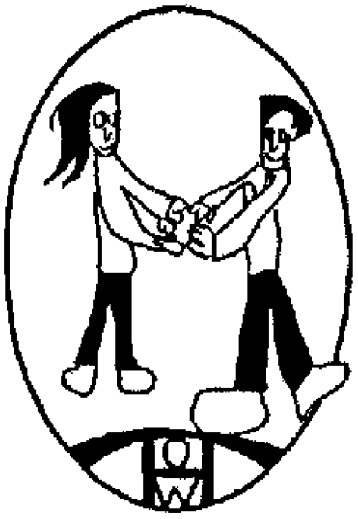
Howbridge Infant School



English as an Additional Language Policy

September 2025

Statement of Aims

Howbridge Infant school is committed to making appropriate provision of teaching and resources for pupils for whom English is an Additional Language (EAL) and for raising the achievement of minority ethnic pupils who are at risk from underachievement. The school will identify individual pupil's needs, recognise the skills they bring to school and ensure equality of access to the curriculum.

We aim to ensure that all EAL pupils are able to:

- Use English confidently and competently
- Use English as a means of learning across the curriculum
- Where appropriate, make use of their knowledge of other languages

The Context of the School

The percentage of children at Howbridge Infant School identified as having English as an Additional Language is well below the national average.

Key Principles for Additional Language Acquisition

- Language develops best when used in purposeful contexts across the curriculum.
- Effective use of language is crucial to the teaching and learning of every subject.
- The language demands of learning tasks need to be identified and planned for, with attention both to initial access and to extension.
- Access to learning requires attention to words and meanings embodied in each curriculum area. Meanings and understandings cannot always be assumed but need to be explored.
- Teachers have a crucial role in modelling uses of language.
- The focus and use of additional support time are best seen as an integral part of curriculum and lesson planning.
- All pupils have an entitlement to the National Curriculum.
- The school applies the principles of inclusion as identified in the National Curriculum 2014.
- A distinction is made between EAL and Special Educational Needs.
- Language is central to our identity. Therefore, teachers need to be aware of the

importance of pupils' home languages and to build on their existing knowledge and skills.

- Many concepts and skills depend on and benefit from well-developed home language and literacy in home language enhances subsequent acquisition of EAL.
- All languages, dialects, accents and cultures are equally valued.

Teaching and Learning

Planning and Differentiation:

The school provides a system for staff to share planning with support staff. Plans identify the demands of the National Curriculum and provide differentiated opportunities matched to individual EAL pupils' needs if required.

Key features of language, which are necessary for effective participation, are identified. These might be key words, certain patterns of grammar, use of language or forms of text.

English and Maths:

Classroom activities are carefully structured and focused to take account of the range of purposes and audiences.

Classroom activities have clear learning objectives and appropriate support and resources are deployed to ensure that pupils are able to participate in lessons. Staff review groupings and setting arrangements to ensure that EAL learners have access to strong English language peer models.

Strategies

Staff use support strategies to ensure curriculum access, for example:

- Collaborative group work
- Enhanced opportunities for speaking and listening
- Effective role models of speaking, reading and writing
- Discussing their family's country of origin during lessons or discussions about countries
- Additional verbal support-repetition, alternative phrasing, peer support
- Additional visual support, e.g. posters, objects, non-verbal clues, pictures, demonstration, use of gesture, etc.

- Bilingual resources, e.g. dictionaries, on-line support, bilingual staff/pupils, texts, key word lists.
- Writing frames
- Opportunities for role play
- Pupils receive regular feedback from staff
- Opportunities are taken to focus on the cultural knowledge explicit or implicit in texts
- Discussion is provided before and during reading and writing activities, using preferred language where appropriate.
- Where possible, learning progression moves from concrete to abstract
- Further support for pupils' language development is provided outside the formal curriculum, e.g. in assemblies, school clubs, etc.

Planning, Monitoring and Evaluation

Information is gathered about:

- the pupils' linguistic background and competence in other languages.
- the pupils' previous educational and schooling experience if appropriate.
- the pupils' family and biographical background.

The pupils' level of English is identified termly with reference to Stages of English as an Additional Language and with reference to the National Curriculum.

Staff regularly observe, assess and record information about pupils' developing use of language. This is reviewed by class teachers and the SENCo.

Whilst account is taken of EAL development, the school aims to set appropriate and challenging targets for individual pupils. These targets are reviewed on a termly basis.

Special Educational Needs and highly able children

The school recognises that most EAL pupils needing additional support do not have SEN needs. However, should SEN needs be identified during assessment; EAL pupils will have equal access to school SEN provision.

Similarly, the school recognises that there may be EAL pupils who are highly able although they may not be fully fluent in English.

Assessment and Record Keeping

Staff have regular liaison to discuss pupil progress, needs and targets.

The school will ensure that all EAL pupils have access to statutory assessments, making full use of special arrangements and support where appropriate.

Staff are aware of the need to ensure children are not impeded by cultural bias when assessing levels of attainment, for example using picture cues which are clear and meaningful to all for reading or spelling words.

The school analyses EAL/Minority Ethnic pupil achievement and regularly evaluates the effectiveness of additional support provided in terms of pupil progress.

Resources

Resources on which reading and writing activities may be based are monitored for grammatical, lexical and cultural accessibility, by the SENCo.

Displays and resources are encouraged to reflect linguistic and cultural diversity, by incorporating key words, dual language books and artefacts from the cultures represented by the school population.

A range of resources are used to support pupils' linguistic development, e.g. games, visual materials, key word lists, bilingual dictionaries, computer software, etc.

Staff are aware of the need for assessment materials and texts to incorporate images which are appropriate for all pupils.

Parents/Carers and the Wider Community

We provide a welcoming admission process for the induction, assessment and support of new arrival pupils and their families/carers. Where needed, additional support will be offered.

We take account of parents/carers linguistic, cultural and religious backgrounds when planning the curriculum and developing home-school links.

We aim to ensure that our written and spoken communication with families and with the community is effective through the use of plain English.

We aim to work closely with members of the wider community to support our EAL pupils.

Review and Evaluation of Policy

School data will include relevant information on minority ethnic/EAL pupils. This will include needs, level of English, support, achievement and progress. This will enable the school to monitor targets.

The evaluation process will serve the basis for planning programmes of action and targeting time, support and resources.

To be reviewed: September 2026